Quality Policy

1. Purpose

The purpose of this document is to define an overall policy with regard to quality management that is appropriate to the purpose of BigCommerce, and includes:

- A framework for setting objectives
- A commitment to satisfying applicable requirements
- A commitment to continual improvement of the QMS

This QMS Policy will be communicated within the organization and to all relevant stakeholders and interested third parties.

As a modern, forward-looking business, BigCommerce recognizes at senior levels the need to ensure that its business operates smoothly and that its products and services satisfy requirements for the benefit of its customers, shareholders and other stakeholders.

In order to provide such assurance, BigCommerce has implemented a Quality Management System (QMS) in line with the international standard for quality management systems, ISO9001.

The operation of this QMS has many benefits for the business, including:

- Protection of revenue streams and company profitability
- Ensuring services meet customer requirements
- Maintenance and enhancement of shareholder value
- Compliance with legal and regulatory requirements

2. Scope

It is important to understand which areas of the business are currently within the umbrella of the QMS and which are excluded. The boundaries of the QMS as implemented within BigCommerce are defined within the document entitled **QMS Context, Requirements and Scope**. It is recommended that this document be reviewed in conjunction with this policy.

The scope comprises the BigCommerce Quality Management System (QMS) supporting the operations underlying the BigCommerce e-commerce SaaS offering, consisting of a cloud-hosted online storefront, a cloud hosted checkout process, and a back-end administration portal, as well as Application Programming Interfaces (APIs) to support these processes. These activities are governed by the requirements described within ISO 9001. The organizational scope includes the Infrastructure Engineering, Legal, Information Technology and Cybersecurity & Governance, Risk and Compliance (GRC) teams affecting the QMS

3. Definitions and Related Documents

Quality Manual

Quality Management Plan

Quality & Performance Status Report

Cortex Workspace for management of OKRs

Criteria for Evaluation and Selection of Suppliers

Procurement Standard Operating Procedure

Quality & Performance Monthly Update

3.1 Control of documents and records

All quality management policies and plans that form part of the QMS must be documented. The way in which these documents are created and managed through their lifecycle is set out in Documented Information Control Policy**.**

All documents in the QMS are uniquely numbered and the current versions are tracked – see document QMS Documentation Log**.**

The keeping of records is a fundamental part of the Quality Management System. Records are key information resources and represent evidence that processes are being carried out effectively. The controls in place to manage records are also defined in the document Documented Information Control Procedure.

4. Policy Statements

4.1 Setting Objectives

The high-level objectives for quality management within BigCommerce are defined within the document **Scope, Objectives, Dependencies & Stakeholders of BC's IMS**. These are fundamental to the nature of the business and are not subject to frequent change.

These overall objectives will be used as guidance in the setting of lower level, more short-term objectives for quality planning within an annual cycle timed to coincide with organizational budget planning. This will ensure that adequate funding is obtained for the improvement activities identified. These objectives will be based upon a clear understanding of the overall business requirements and how they may change during the year.

Quality objectives will be documented in the **Quality Management Plan** for the relevant financial year, together with details of a plan for how they will be achieved. Once approved, this plan will be reviewed on a quarterly basis as part of the management review process, at which time the objectives will also be reviewed to ensure that they remain valid. If amendments are required, these will be managed through the organizational change management process.

4.2 Commitment to satisfying applicable requirements

Commitment to the delivery of quality management extends to senior levels of the organization and will be demonstrated through this **Quality Policy** and the provision of appropriate resources to establish and develop the Quality Management System.

Senior management will also ensure that a systematic review of performance of the program is conducted on a regular basis to ensure that quality objectives are being met and quality issues are identified through the audit program and management processes. Management Review can take several forms including departmental and other management meetings. Within the field of Quality Management, there are several key roles that need to be undertaken to ensure the success of the QMS and protect the business from risk.

The GRC Quality Officer shall have overall authority and responsibility for the implementation and management of the Quality Management System, specifically:

- The identification, documentation and fulfillment of applicable requirements
- Tracking authorities and responsibilities for the implementation, management and improvement of quality management processes
- Integration of business processes with the QMS
- Compliance with statutory, regulatory and contractual requirements in the management of assets used to deliver products and services
- Reporting to senior management on performance and improvement of the QMS

It is also the responsibility of the GRC Quality Officer in collaboration with Quality Leadership to ensure that employees understand the roles they are required to fulfill and that they have appropriate skills and competence to do so.

BigCommerce will ensure that all employees involved in quality management are competent based on appropriate education, training, skills and experience. The skills required to ensure business quality will be determined and reviewed on a regular basis together with an assessment of existing skill levels within BigCommerce. Training needs will be identified, and a plan maintained to ensure that the necessary competencies are in place.

Training, education and other relevant records will be kept by the GRC Quality Officer to document individual skill levels attained.

Full details of the responsibilities associated with each of the required roles and how they are allocated within BigCommerce are given in a separate document entitled Information Management System Roles, Responsibilities & Authorities.

BigCommerce makes use of various third parties, both internal and external, in the delivery of products and services to its customers. Where this involves the operation of a business process, or a part of the process on behalf of BigCommerce, that falls within the defined scope of the QMS, this is identified in the Quality Management Plan.

In all cases, BigCommerce will retain governance of the relevant quality management processes by demonstrating:

- Accountability for the process
- Control of the definition of and interface to the process
- Performance and compliance monitoring
- Control over process improvements

This will be evidenced by documents and records such as contracts, meeting minutes and performance reports.

4.3 Continual improvement of the QMS

BigCommerce's policy regarding Continual Improvement of the QMS is to:

- Continually improve the effectiveness of the Quality Management System across all areas within scope
- Enhance current processes to bring them into line with good practice as defined within ISO 9001
- Achieve ISO 9001 certification and maintain it on an on-going basis
- Increase the level of proactivity (and the business perception of proactivity) regarding the on-going management of quality
- Achieve an enhanced understanding of, and relationship with, the business units to which the QMS applies
- Review relevant metrics on an annual basis to assess whether it is appropriate to change them, based on collected historical data and feedback from relevant sources
- Obtain ideas for improvement via regular review meetings with stakeholders and document them
- Review ideas for continual improvement at regular management meetings in order to prioritize them and assess timescales and benefits

Ideas for improvements may be obtained from any source including customers, suppliers, employees, risk assessments and audits. Once identified they will be documented and evaluated by the staff member responsible for continual improvement.

As part of the evaluation of proposed improvements, the following criteria will be used:

- Cost
- Business Benefit
- Risk
- Implementation timescale
- Resource requirements

If accepted, the improvement proposal will be prioritized in order to allow more effective planning.

1.4 Approach to managing risks and opportunities

Risk and opportunity management will take place at several levels within the Quality Management System, including:

- Quality planning – risks to the achievement of quality objectives
- QMS-wide risk and opportunity management
- As part of the business change management process
- As part of individual business projects

High level risk and opportunity assessments will be reviewed on an annual basis, or upon significant change to the business environment. For more detail on the approach to risk assessment please review the document QMS Risk & Opportunity Action Plan.

Once in place, it is vital that regular reviews take place of how well quality management processes and procedures are being adhered to. This will happen at three levels:

1. Structured regular management review of conformity to policies and procedures within BigCommerce

2. Internal audit reviews against the ISO 9001 standard by the BigCommerce Quality Team
3. External audit against the standard in order to gain and maintain certification to ISO 9001

Details of how internal audits will be carried out can be found in the Internal Audit Policy and Procedure for Internal Audits.

5. Compliance

5.1 Compliance Management

The *Governance Risk & Compliance Team* will verify compliance with this policy through various methods, including but not limited to, business tool reports, internal and external audits, and feedback to the policy owner.

5.2 Exceptions

Any exception to this policy must be agreed to by the Information Security Compliance team in advance, and documented as per the BigCommerce Policy Exception Procedure.

Policy Exception Standard
Information Security Policy Exception Intake Form
Policy Exception Tracking

5.3 Non-Compliance

Any employee found to have violated this policy may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

6. Records Kept

Record Name	Storage Location	Person Responsible	Controls for Record Protection	Retention Period
QMS Risk and Opportunity Assessment Report	Confluence	@ Susan Phillips	RBAC Access Controls	3 years
QMS Risk and Opportunity Assessment Process	Confluence	@ Susan Phillips	RBAC Access Controls	3 years
QMS Risk and Opportunity Action Plan	Confluence	@ Susan Phillips	RBAC Access Controls	3 years

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Version History

Version	Published	Author	Description	Approved By
1.0	13 Aug 2023	Susan Philips	Original Draft.	@ Dan Holden
1.1	21 Sep 2024	Susan Phillips	Added links to relevant QMS artifacts	@ Dan Holden